From: **Rob Reuss** robreuss@mac.com
Subject: Re: Follow-on notes
Date: February 9, 2026 at 9:12 AM
To: Marc Weiss mweiss@weblab.org

I'm diving into this not so much to determine the number of participants as I am to figure out the extent to which we can discern a relationship between multiple posts with individual participants - that's only possible if either the name or e-mail address is consistent across their posts.

I've attached "analysis.txt" which shows how many matchings I was able to create among posts to a given user - that is, in how many cases do we know a user made more than one post, so we can identify them as a unique "speaker" using either their posted name or e-mail address.

The result is 162 users who posted at least two times in an identifiable way. Here's some really interesting analysis of that file by ChatGPT - it's amazing how much can be extracted from such a small amount of data!

Forum Dialogue Durability Analysis
chatgpt.com

I was able to find 545 unique, correctly formed e-mail addresses - attached as "email_addresses_correct.csv". 545 is a pretty firm "at least this many participants" number - the only edge case would be a participant who used more than one e-mail address when commenting.

You'll see in "email_addresses_malformed.csv" the range of values (542) that people put into the e-mail address field for varying reasons -some of them are pretty funny and I think it became a running joke on the forum. The detective in me thinks that many of the jokes were made by the same individual. Many are legitimate e-mail addresses with typos or dropped components of the address (like the "@" symbol). My guess would be that there are probably 100-200 unique individuals there.

email_addresses_correct.csv

email_addresses_malformed.csv

analysis.txt

> On Feb 8, 2026, at 7:16 PM, Marc Weiss <mweiss@weblab.org> wrote:
>
> This is funny (I could see the “addresses” in what you sent me even though they’re not showing when I reply).
>
> Approx number of participants would be interesting but not worth a lot of effort.
>
> About to eat dinner but will be finishing up letter and getting back to you re your earlier email after I eat.
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>> On Feb 8, 2026, at 6:49 PM, Rob Reuss <robreuss@mac.com> wrote:
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>> I left an additional directory out of the analysis - not too many posts in it, but I’ll include it in the next go-around.
>>
>> It occurs to me that I can generate a de-duplicated list of e-mail addresses next and that’ll give a much better count of participants, if that matters. More important, it’s simply a more reliable identifier.
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>> Here’s some bogus e-mail addresses people entered...
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